



M

MANUFACTURING IS THE backbone of economic development, and India aims to become a global manufacturing hub by 2047. While technology will be a part of this journey, it has to be the right fit. “Technology must work for business,” says Jayanta Banerjee, Tata

Steel’s Group Chief Information Officer (CIO), emphatically. That’s not easy to accomplish amid a tech disruption when there are constant discussions on smart manufacturing and the high investments involved.

That said, shop floors across manufacturing firms have undergone a remarkable transformation thanks to the disruption. At Tata Steel, for instance, the entire agglomeration operation—a type of conditioning of iron ore before it makes its way to the blast furnace—is now done by people sitting in an air-conditioned room in Jamshedpur through an array of LED screens. “Our mines are 350 km away, but it hardly matters,” says Banerjee, adding that in the

BRICK BY BRICK



A western template of Industry 4.0, which involves replacing humans with automation, is unlikely to be effective in India



While technologies like AI and ML are used now in India, the challenge is always to make them relevant to the manufacturing process



The government’s investments in reducing logistics costs and improving infrastructure are positives in transforming India into a global manufacturing hub



The need for specific skills will gain more importance as manufacturing gets more sophisticated



Experts demand more robust government policies to propel investment in Indian manufacturing